

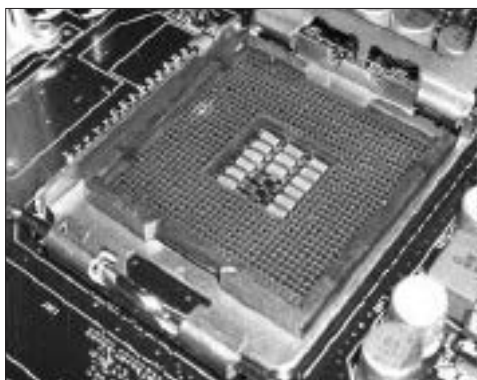
of the bus is doubled. To use the memory in dual-channel mode, one slot in each bank needs to be fitted with RAM modules that are similar in all respects.

1.1.18 Serial port

DB 9 or Serial port is a 9-pin port that transfers data serially. It is increasingly being left out from the back panel in favour of faster ports like USB. It is used today mostly for external modems.

1.1.19 Socket

The motherboard carries the interface to connect the CPU. This is referred to as a Socket. There are many socket types, with no clear naming scheme, though most are named after the number of pin sockets they contain. The latest Intel CPUs require a Socket 775 interface,



Screenshot 12: Socket 775.jpeg

while the latest AMD processors require a Socket AM2 interface. Some older CPUs like the Pentium 2 used a slot-like interface, called Slot 1.

1.1.20 USB ports

USB ports are ubiquitous, with many newer motherboards offering up to 10 USB connections. USB is available in two common versions - version 1.1, which has a maximum data transfer rate of 12 Megabits per second, and version 2, which tops out at 480 Megabits per second. Besides speed, USB also allows up to 116 compatible devices to be connected in a daisy-chain into a single port, and it also supports hot-swapping (the system would detect the newly-connected device without requiring a restart).